



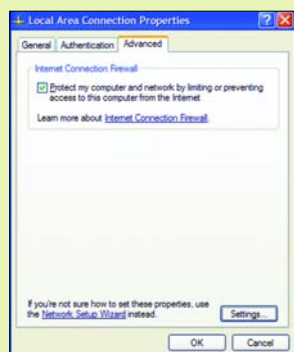
Securing Your Windows XP System with In-built Tools

Just set up a new installation of Windows XP Professional? Here is what you need to do to secure the PC using in-built tools in Windows XP

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Enable Firewall

Before you connect to the Internet or your LAN, enable the built-in firewall—without this, your PC may be infected with Blaster or Sasser within minutes of connecting. To do so:



Internet Connection Firewall

1. Go to Start > Control Panel > Network and Internet Connections > Network Connections.

2. Right click on the connection you want to protect and click Properties.

3. Click on the Advanced tab and then select 'Protect my computer and network by limiting or preventing access to this computer from the Internet.' Click OK.

Install Security Updates

Security updates protect your computer from vulnerabilities and malicious code. Whenever threats are detected, Microsoft promptly releases security patches for their OSes. Windows XP comes with an automatic update feature that downloads new patches automatically. To activate it:

1. Go to Start > Control Panel > Performance & Maintenance > System.

2. Click Automatic Updates, and then select Keep my computer up to date.
3. Select an appropriate setting. You can specify a schedule as to when the updates will be downloaded and installed.

Since Automatic Update only installs future updates, you will also need to go to the Microsoft Web site for updates and install the latest available updates.

1. Go to <http://windowsupdate.microsoft.com>
2. Click 'Scan for Updates.' Windows Update scans your computer and displays a pre-selected list of critical updates.
3. Under 'Pick updates to install,' click 'Critical Updates and Service Packs'. A list of the updates that are appropriate is generated. Critical updates are selected for download by default.
4. Click 'Review and install updates.'
5. Select the updates and then click Install Now.

Create Users

The User Accounts features in Windows XP can also be used to protect your computer from unauthorised access. To avoid misuse, you can create limited user accounts. If your PC is 'hacked' while you are logged in as a 'limited' user, the hacker can only inflict limited damage. To set up a user account:

1. Go to Start > Control Panel > User Accounts.

2. Under Pick a task, click Create a new account.
3. On the 'Name the new account' window, type a name for the new account. Click Next.
4. On the 'Pick an account type' page, click the type of account, and click Create Account.

You need to assign a password to your administrator account so that only you can access it:

1. Go to Start > Control Panel > User Accounts.
2. Under 'Pick an account to change,' select and click on the name of your account.
3. On the 'What do you want to change about your account' page, click 'Create a password.'
4. In the 'Type a new password' box, enter a password, and follow the steps that come up.
5. Click 'Create Password.'

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Also Remember

- ▶ Install an antivirus software, such as the free AVG or Avast anti-virus solutions to protect your computer from viruses. Let the software get automatic updates to its virus definitions to make sure that you are immune to the latest threats.
- ▶ Do not open unidentified e-mail attachments.
- ▶ Do not share passwords and credit card numbers with anyone over the Internet.



The settings for Automatic Updates



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